How-To Library

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Using Parameters for General Session Properties

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Abstract

You can use the general session parameter, $Param*Name*, to define a parameter for a general session property. This article describes how to add a general session parameter to a session, create a parameter file to define the value of the parameter, and configure the parameter file name and location.

Supported Versions

- PowerCenter 8.5 - 9.1.0

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Overview

Session parameters represent values that can change between session runs. You can use different session parameter types to define the following session information:

- Session log file name
- Number of partitions for a session
- Source, lookup, target, or reject file name
- Database, external loader, FTP, queue, source application, or target application connection

You can use the general session parameter $Param*Name* to define any other session property. For example, you can use this parameter to define a table owner name, table name prefix, FTP file or directory name, lookup cache file name prefix, or email address. You can also use this parameter to define source, lookup, target, and reject file names, but not the session log file name or connections.

You define the value to use for a parameter in a parameter file. A parameter file contains a list of parameters and variables with assigned values. The PowerCenter Integration Service reads the parameter file at the start of the workflow or session to determine the start values for the parameters and variables defined in the file.

Parameter files provide the flexibility to change the parameter and variable values each time you run a workflow or session.

To use a parameter for a general session property, complete the following steps:

1. Add a general session parameter to the session.
2. Create a parameter file.
3. Configure the parameter file name and location.

Step 1. Add a General Session Parameter to a Session

A general session parameter defines the value of a general session property. Name the parameter with the following naming convention:

```
$ParamName
```

For example, you might define a general session parameter for an FTP remote file name as $ParamFTPSourceFile. Or, you might define a general session parameter for a target table name prefix as $ParamTargetTablePrefix.

Enter the parameter name in the appropriate session property field. For example, enter $ParamFTPSourceFile in the FTP remote file name field in the Mapping tab of the session properties.

Step 2. Create a Parameter File

A parameter file contains a list of parameters and variables with assigned values. Create a parameter file using a text editor such as WordPad or Notepad.

You group parameters and variables in different sections of the parameter file. Precede each section with a heading that identifies the session for which you want to define parameters or variables. Use the following format for the heading:

```
[foldername.WF:workflow name.ST:session name]
```

You define parameters and variables directly below the heading, entering each parameter or variable on a new line. Enter the parameter definition in the form *name=value*.

For example, you need to define the value of a general session parameter named $ParamFTPSourceFile that you added to the session s_SOURCE_EXTRACTION. Create a text file named FTPSource.txt and enter the following text in the file:

```
[TestFolder.WF:wf_SOURCE_EXTRACTION.ST:s_SOURCE_EXTRACTION]
$ParamFTPSourceFile =c:\staging\customers.txt
```

Store each parameter file in $PMRootDir, the root directory on the node running the PowerCenter Integration Service.

You can create a single parameter file and change the parameter values each time you run a workflow or session. Or, you can create multiple parameter files that define different values for the same parameter. Then, use the pmcmd command line program to run the workflow or session, specifying a different parameter file for each workflow or session run.

Step 3. Configure the Parameter File Name and Location

You can specify the parameter file name and location in the workflow properties, session properties, or in the pmcmd command line program.

The parameter file that you use with pmcmd overrides the parameter file in the workflow or session properties. If you do not enter a parameter file name in pmcmd, the PowerCenter Integration Service uses the parameter file specified in the workflow properties. If you do not enter a parameter file name in pmcmd or the workflow properties, the PowerCenter Integration Service uses the parameter file specified in the session properties.

Entering a Parameter File in the Workflow Properties

1. Open a workflow in the Workflow Manager.
2. Click **Workflows** > **Edit**.
3. On the **Properties** tab, enter the parameter file location and name in the **Parameter Filename** field.
4. Click **OK**.

   The PowerCenter Integration Service reads the parameter file when the workflow runs.

Entering a Parameter File in the Session Properties

1. Open a session in the Workflow Manager.
2. On the **Properties** tab, open the **General Options** settings.
3. Enter the parameter file location and name in the **Parameter Filename** field.
4. Click **OK**.

   The PowerCenter Integration Service reads the parameter file when the session runs.

Specifying a Parameter File Using pmcmd

You can specify a parameter file with the pmcmd StartWorkflow or StartTask command. The -paramfile option defines which parameter file to use when a session or workflow runs.

The following command starts workflow wf_SOURCE_EXTRACTION using the parameter file FTPSource.txt:

```
pmcmd StartWorkflow -service PCIS -user Administrator -password Administrator -folder
TestFolder -paramfile "$PMRootDir\FTPSource.txt" wf_SOURCE_EXTRACTION
```

The following command starts session s_SOURCE_EXTRACTION using the parameter file FTPSource.txt:

```
pmcmd StartTask -service PCIS -user Administrator -password Administrator -folder TestFolder -
workflow wf_SOURCE_EXTRACTION -paramfile "$PMRootDir\FTPSource.txt" s_SOURCE_EXTRACTION
```

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Acknowledgements

The author would like to acknowledge the Informatica Development and Quality Assurance teams for their contributions to this article.